

ICF Word Study

Moscow Good News Church

Being Led by the Written Word (*Logos*)

Bible Study Series — Part 1 of 2

Psalm 119:105 · 2 Timothy 3:16–17

~ *Roger Nick Anaedevha*

March 20, 2026

Series Overview

PART 1 — TODAY

Being Led by the Written Word (Logos)

Psalm 119:105 / 2 Tim 3:16–17

*The Bible as our foundational
lamp and God-breathed authority.*

PART 2 — MARCH 27

Living by the Spoken Word (Rhema)

Matthew 4:4 / John 6:63

*How God makes His written
Word personal and alive for you.*

KEY PRINCIPLE: Logos must come before Rhema — the written Word is the foundation

What Is Logos?_____

OUTWARD FORM

Word, speech, decree, precept, discourse, doctrine

INWARD THOUGHT

Reason, logic, the faculty of thinking and reckoning

DIVINE PERSON

Christ himself — the eternal Word made flesh (John 1:1, 14)

John 1:1, 14

“In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. . .

And the Word became flesh and dwelt among us.”

The written Word (Scripture) and the living Word (Christ) are inseparable.

Psalm 119:105 — Lamp & Light

“Your word is a lamp to my feet and a light to my path.”

NER — Lamp to My Feet

Immediate Guidance

Small handheld oil lamp — carried by travelers at night in ancient towns without street lamps.

→ **Present decisions, current problems, the very next step you need to take.**

OR — Light to My Path

Broader Direction

Wider illumination — seeing the trajectory of your journey and God's purposes for life.

→ **Life direction, moral vision, long-range spiritual discernment.**

2 Timothy 3:16–17 — God-Breathed

theopneustos

Hapax legomenon — only once in the NT

= “God-breathed OUT”

**Key Insight — B.B. Warfield
(1915)**

Connects to Genesis 2:7 (God breathes life into Adam) and Psalm 33:6 (the heavens made by God’s breath). God’s breath is the bearer of His creative word.

The Four Purposes of Scripture

TEACHING — Shows what is **right**

REPROOF — Shows what is **wrong**

CORRECTION — Restores what is **broken**

TRAINING — Builds what is **needed**

Logos vs. Rhema — A Balanced View

Charismatic Perspective

Logos = Written canon (the Bible)

Rhema = Personal/spoken word from God

When the Spirit quickens a passage, the Logos becomes Rhema — alive and personal for your situation.

— *Watchman Nee, Kenneth Hagin*

Scholarly Observation

D.A. Carson (*Exegetical Fallacies*):

Logos & Rhema are used interchangeably in the NT. Building rigid theology on Greek word distinctions the original authors didn't intend is precarious.

Example: 1 Peter 1:25 uses *rhema* for written Scripture.

BALANCED APPROACH

The Spirit does illuminate specific passages personally — this is real. Call it *illumination and application* rather than a separate revelation. Any claimed word must be tested by the written Word.

Biblical Examples: Led by the Written Word

Joshua 1:8

The Leader Who Meditated

God's first command to Joshua wasn't military strategy — it was to meditate (*hagah* = mutter like a lion growling) on the Book of the Law day and night.

Matthew 4:1–11

Jesus vs. Temptation

Jesus fought every temptation with “It is written” — quoting Deuteronomy. He chose existing Scripture over new revelation or divine power.

Acts 17:10–11

The Noble Bereans

Called “more noble-minded” because they combined eagerness (received the word gladly) with discernment (examined Scriptures daily).

Biblical Examples (continued)

Nehemiah 8

Ezra Reads the Law

After 70 years in exile, the people themselves asked for the Book of the Law. Ezra read 5–6 hours. The Levites helped explain.

Understanding → Conviction (weeping) → Obedience → Great Joy

2 Kings 22–23

Josiah's Rediscovery

The Book of the Law was literally *lost in the temple* during decades of idolatry. When Josiah heard it read, he tore his clothes and launched Judah's greatest reformation.

Sobering: A generation can lose its Scriptures.

The “Power of 4” — Research You Need to Know

100,000+

people surveyed over 8 years
(Center for Bible Engagement)

THE THRESHOLD

1–3 times/week

= Same as NOT reading at all

4+ times/week

= Dramatic transformation spike!

LOWER at 4+/week

Drinking to excess, pornography, lashing out in anger, gossiping, lying, gambling

HIGHER at 4+/week

Faith-sharing, spiritual growth, moral decision-making, resilience, proactive service

Discussion Questions

KEY UNDERTONE QUESTIONS

1. If Scripture is sufficient, why do believers still struggle with direction?
2. What does it mean *practically* that Scripture is God-breathed?
3. The Bereans searched daily. What would that look like for you?
4. What prevents you from crossing the 4 times/week threshold?

CONTRASTING QUESTIONS

1. Can the written Word become a personal Rhema word? How?
2. Is reading enough, or must the Spirit always accompany?
3. How do we avoid bibliolatry while honoring Scripture's authority?
4. Is it possible to know the Bible intellectually but miss its power?

Voices Across the Ages

“The Bible is alive, it speaks to me; it has feet, it runs after me; it has hands, it lays hold of me.”

— Martin Luther

“Oh, give me that book! At any price, give me the book of God!”

— John Wesley

“Nobody ever outgrows Scripture; the Book widens and deepens with our years.”

— Charles Spurgeon

“Whatever keeps me from my Bible is my enemy, however harmless it may appear.”

— A.W. Tozer

“I like to read mine in the Holy Ghost.”

— Smith Wigglesworth (Pentecostal pioneer)

Take-Home Tasks This Week

1

Power of 4 Challenge

Read Scripture at least 4 days this week.

Memorize Psalm 119:105 +

2

2 Tim. 3:16-17

Hagar method. Read aloud, write by hand, recite 10x, review daily.

3

Journal Prompt

Write about a time God's Word guided you. If you can't — what does that reveal?

4

Hagar Meditation Exercise

Whisper Psalm 119:105 — emphasize a different word each time. Like a lion over prey.

The Written Word Comes First

In every biblical example, the pattern is the same:

- Joshua needed the Book of the Law before battle.
- Jesus used “It is written” before new revelation.
- The Bereans tested spoken teaching against Scripture.
- Ezra read the Torah — revival broke out.
- Josiah found the Law — reformation followed.

THE GUARDRAIL PRINCIPLE

The Logos provides the framework and guardrails within which the Rhema operates. Any personal word, prophecy, or impression that contradicts Scripture is not from God. The more you know the written Word, the more accurately you can discern God's voice.

*“Open my eyes, that I may behold
wondrous things out of your law.”*

— Psalm 119:18

NEXT SESSION

Living by the Spoken Word (*Rhema*)

Matthew 4:4 · John 6:63

March 27, 2026

*How does God make the written Word come alive personally?
How does a verse you've read a hundred times suddenly pierce
your heart at the exact right moment?*

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